

BLESSED ARE THOSE WHO MOURN

A Scripture-Integrated Grief Workbook

Matthew 5:4 - For they will be comforted.

By Daniel Tesfamariam

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If in crisis: 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline

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UNDERSTANDING GRIEF

Grief is love with nowhere to go.

The 5 stages (not linear - you may go back and forth):

1. Denial - This can't be real
2. Anger - Why did this happen?
3. Bargaining - What if I had...
4. Depression - The weight of loss
5. Acceptance - Learning to live with loss

Biblical model of grief:

- Lament (cry out to God honestly)
- Remember (hold onto memories)
- Hope (trust in God's promises)
- Comfort others (2 Corinthians 1:3-4)

There is no timeline for grief. Give yourself grace.

IT'S OKAY TO GRIEVE

Jesus Wept - John 11:35

Jesus stood at the tomb of his friend Lazarus and WEPT.

He knew He was about to raise Lazarus from the dead.

He wept anyway. Grief is not a lack of faith.

You have permission to:

- Cry as long as you need
- Feel angry (even at God - He can handle it)
- Not be okay for a while
- Miss them every single day
- Say 'I'm not fine' when people ask

You do NOT have to:

- 'Be strong' for everyone else
- 'Get over it' on anyone's timeline
- Pretend faith makes grief disappear
- Feel guilty for moments of joy

COMPLICATED GRIEF - DO I NEED EXTRA HELP?

Check if you experience these for more than 6 months:

- ☐ Intense longing that doesn't lessen at all
- ☐ Inability to accept the death
- ☐ Feeling life has no purpose without them
- ☐ Difficulty trusting others since the loss
- ☐ Feeling numb or detached from life
- ☐ Bitterness or anger about the death
- ☐ Avoiding reminders of the person
- ☐ Wishing you had died instead

If 4+ checked: Please seek grief counseling.

This is not weakness - it's wisdom.

CONTINUING BONDS

Not 'moving on' but 'moving forward'

You don't have to 'let go' of your loved one.

Your relationship continues - it just changes form.

Ways to maintain connection:

- Talk to them (it's not crazy!)
- Keep traditions that honor them
- Share stories with others
- Write them letters
- Do something they would have loved

My favorite memory of them:

STUCK POINTS + SCRIPTURE

Stuck point: 'God took them to punish me'

Truth: Romans 8:1 - No condemnation in Christ

Stuck point: 'I should have done more'

Truth: Psalm 139:16 - All days are written in His book

Stuck point: 'I'll never be happy again'

Truth: Psalm 30:5 - Joy comes in the morning

Stuck point: 'God doesn't care'

Truth: Psalm 34:18 - The LORD is near to the brokenhearted

MY stuck point:

Scripture that speaks to this:

MEANING-MAKING THROUGH FAITH

Meaning-making doesn't mean the loss 'makes sense.'

It means finding purpose even in the pain.

Questions to explore:

- How has this loss changed me?
- What have I learned about what matters?
- How can my pain help others? (2 Cor 1:3-4)
- What would my loved one want for me?
- Where have I seen God in this darkness?

My reflections:

HOLIDAY & ANNIVERSARY COPING PLAN

Holidays and anniversaries can be especially hard.

Plan ahead so you're not caught off guard:

Difficult dates: _____

What I'll do to honor them: _____

Who will be with me: _____

My permission to leave if overwhelmed: YES

Scripture to hold onto: _____

A new tradition that honors them: _____

'He will wipe every tear from their eyes.' - Rev 21:4

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 1

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10):

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 2

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10):

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 3

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 4

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10):

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 5

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 6

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 7

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 8

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 9

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10):

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 10

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 11

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 12

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 13

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 14

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 15

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 16

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 17

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 18

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 19

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 20

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 21

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 22

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 23

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 24

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 25

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 26

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 27

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 28

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 29

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

GRIEF JOURNAL - DAY 30

Date: _____

Grief level today (1-10): _____

Where I found God today:

One thing I'm grateful for:

Scripture that held me:

My prayer:

MEMORY PRESERVATION

Their name:

What I called them:

Their laugh was like:

Their favorite food:

A phrase they always said:

What they taught me:

My happiest memory with them:

What I wish I'd said:

What I know they'd say to me now:

HOPE: REUNION PROMISES

John 14:2-3 - I go to prepare a place for you.

1 Thess 4:13-14 - We do not grieve as those without hope.

Revelation 21:4 - No more death, mourning, crying, or pain.

John 11:25 - I am the resurrection and the life.

Psalms 116:15 - Precious in the sight of the LORD is the death of his saints.

2 Corinthians 5:8 - Absent from body, present with the Lord.

The promise that gives me most hope:

SUPPORT RESOURCES

- 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline
- GriefShare (church-based grief support groups)
- Celebrate Recovery
- Your church pastoral care team
- Christian grief counselor
- Hospice bereavement services (free)